GLOSSARY

Charge - To make a rush at or sudden attack upon a person or thing

Clamber - Climb or move in an awkward and laborious way using both hands and feet

Brambles - A prickly scrambling shrub of the rose family especially a blackberry

Tramp - A person who travels from place to place on foot in search of work or as a beggar

Stringing - Hang so that it stretches in a long line

Lumping - Carry with difficulty

Glimpse - See or perceive briefly or partially

READ AND UNDERSTAND

2CPH2P

A. Read the lines and answer the questions given below.

1. *Faster than fairies, faster than witches,*
   Bridges and houses, hedges and ditches;

a. What is faster than fairies and witches?

b. Why does the poet mention 'bridges and houses, hedges and ditches'? Where are they?

2. *Here is a child who clambers and scrambles,*
   All by himself and gathering brambles;

a. Where do you think the child is?

b. What does 'gathering brambles' mean?

3. *And ever again, in the wink of an eye,*
   Painted stations whistle by.

a. 'In the wink of an eye' means very quickly. Explain 'painted stations whistle by'.

4. *Each a glimpse and gone forever;*

a. What is 'each' over here? Why is it gone forever?

B. Answer the following questions.

1. What does 'charges along like troops in a battle' mean?
2. What word could best replace 'charges' in the poem - marches, rushes or pushes?
3. Why does the child clamber and scramble?

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